

# Before We Move In

The things worth talking through before the keys change hands, with space under each one to write down what we decide.

| UNIT           | RENT   | EACH   | DEPOSIT | MOVING    |
|----------------|--------|--------|---------|-----------|
| 2 bed / 2 bath | R8,800 | R4,400 | R9,000  | Month end |

Rent covers sanitation, refuse and security. Electricity and internet are on top.

## Agenda

Seven things to run through together. Most of them are quick — the point is simply to have said them out loud once, and to have somewhere to look them up later.

- 01

Money

What we are each putting in at move-in, and what runs monthly

☐
- 02

Furniture

What we each have, what we still need, what we buy together

☐
- 03

Running the home

Cleaning, food, laundry, and how we keep it easy

☐
- 04

People in the home

Guests, and the ministry boundary we have already agreed

☐
- 05

The view from outside

What the church and our families are told, by whom, and when

☐
- 06

Home, church and everything else

Keeping home a place where either of us can raise something small

☐

Notice, and what we would want already agreed

Each item has space for notes underneath it. Anything we leave open goes to the actions block on the last page.

# What we are working through

The questions set in italic are the ones worth asking out loud. In the notes box under each item, write what we decided rather than what we discussed — it is much more useful to read back.

## 01 Money

The split is settled — everything shared, down the middle. Both names are on the lease. What is left is agreeing the numbers and filling in the ones still outstanding.

### ONCE-OFF, AT MOVE-IN

| ITEM             | TOTAL   | EACH   |
|------------------|---------|--------|
| Deposit          | R9,000  | R4,500 |
| First month rent | R8,800  | R4,400 |
| Admin fee        | R950    | R475   |
| Credit check     | R150    | R75    |
| Total            | R18,900 | R9,450 |

### EVERY MONTH

| ITEM                        | TOTAL                                            | EACH   |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Rent                        | R8,800                                           | R4,400 |
| Electricity                 | <i>to confirm — may be in the month-end bill</i> |        |
| Gas refill                  |                                                  |        |
| Transport — Sundays, shared | R900                                             | R450   |

ITEM

TOTAL

EACH

## Total

Blank rows are for anything we add — groceries, internet, a cleaner, anything else that ends up shared.

## STILL TO AGREE

- ☐ Set the monthly household budget, and what it covers.  
Groceries, cleaning supplies, toilet paper and the rest — one figure rather than counting individual items.
- ☐ What date does money move each month, relative to both our salary dates?
- ☐ Keep a simple record of who paid what at move-in.  
Only matters once, at the end of the lease, when the deposit is refunded. Easier to write down now than to reconstruct later.
- ☐ Confirm what the electricity arrangement actually is once the first bill arrives.

*If one of us is short one month, how do we want to handle it?*

01 • WHAT WE AGREED

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## 02 Furniture

Rooms are sorted and neither of us has a car, so this is just about what goes in the flat.

- ☐ What each of us is bringing.
- ☐ What is still missing, and roughly what it will cost.

☐ What we buy together, and what stays personal.

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☐ For anything bought together — who keeps it if one of us moves on, and whether the other is bought out.

Five minutes now, and nobody has to work it out under pressure later.

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☐ Contents insurance — separately, or one policy split between us?

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#### 02 • WHAT WE AGREED

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### 03 Running the home

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☐ How we share the cleaning between us.

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☐ What "tidy" means for the kitchen and the lounge, specifically.

Dishes done the same night, or by the next morning? Easier agreed than assumed.

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☐ Food: shared, separate, or shared staples with separate meals.

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☐ Fridge and cupboard space.

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☐ Anything either of us needs in order to rest properly at home.

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#### 03 • WHAT WE AGREED

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## 04 People in the home

- ☐ How does the church come to understand that this address is private, and who handles that?  
Better known from the start than corrected after the first person arrives.
- ☐ If someone does turn up, what do we do?  
Agreed now, so neither of us has to think on the spot.
- ☐ Is it absolute, or are there exceptions we would both agree to first?
- ☐ Pastoral calls will still happen in the flat even when visitors do not — where are they taken, and what would be helpful from me while they are happening?

### OUR OWN GUESTS

- ☐ How much notice before someone comes over?
- ☐ Overnight guests — how often, and how much warning?
- ☐ How either of us says "not this week" without it being awkward.

*What does a normal week at home look like for each of us?*

04 • WHAT WE AGREED

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## 05 The view from outside

Word will travel gently either way, and that is fine. It simply helps to have spoken about it once between ourselves, so that whatever is said is something we are both at peace with.

- ☐ What does the church know, and what would we like it to be told?

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## 06 Home, church and everything else

We already talk easily, which is most of this. The rest is just making sure the flat stays a place where the small things get said early — the dishes, the noise, the thing that has been mildly annoying for a fortnight — and that they land as household things rather than anything bigger.

- ☐ Agree that household matters get sorted between us as equals, whatever else is going on.
- ☐ Keep home conversations and church conversations in separate moments where we can.
- ☐ A short check-in once a month — fifteen minutes, nothing formal.  
Small things raised early stay small.

*When something small bothers one of us, how do we want to hear about it?*

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## 07 If plans change

Not because anything is expected to. It is simply much easier to agree this now, while everyone is looking forward to the move, than to work it out in the middle of whatever prompts it.

### NOTICE AND EXIT

- ☐ How much notice do we give each other if one of us needs to move on?

- ☐ Who finds a replacement, and do we both have to be happy with them?
- ☐ Who covers the shortfall while the room is empty?
- ☐ Is the deposit settled at the point someone leaves, or when the lease ends?

#### THE LEASE IS TWELVE MONTHS

Whatever happens between us, the lease runs its term and we are both on it. Worth one short conversation about what we would want to have already agreed if things changed — who would stay, what notice, and how the costs are handled — so it is a decision we made together in a good moment.

*If things changed between us, what would we want to have already agreed about the flat?*

07 · WHAT WE AGREED

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## Left open, and who is doing it

Anything we could not settle today. A name and a date against each one, or it quietly does not happen.

ACTIONS    what · who · by when

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Most of this will never be needed. We will settle into a rhythm and the page will sit in a drawer. That is rather the point of it — the arrangements that last are the ones where nobody has to guess what was agreed.